

# Apply to be a Science Corps Fellow - Entry #3371

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| <b>Name</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Brian Ko                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Email</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <a href="mailto:brianserivuthko@gmail.com">brianserivuthko@gmail.com</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Gender</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Male                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Residence: City (State), Country</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Bryan, Texas, USA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Nationality</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| USA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>When did you or do you expect to complete your PhD?</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Feb 2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Please tell us briefly about your university education (institution, city, country, year)</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Bachelor of Science in Biological Engineering and Minor in Economics at Mississippi State University, Starkville, US, 2015-2019                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Doctorate in Biomedical Engineering at Texas A&M University, College Station, USA, 2019-2025                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Why would you like to be a Science Corps Fellow?</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <p>Being able to see a student's face light up when they encounter a concept for the first time is priceless, regardless of the subject. I was one of those students back in my Mississippi middle school science class playing with oobleck for the first time, desperately flipping through the science textbook trying to find out more about this strange goop.</p> <p>Science, as inquiry into the world around us, should be one of the easiest to be involved with, but that isn't quite as practical around the world with economic and social pressures sometimes getting in the way of sheer curiosity. I remember picking at the side of a small creek in a park as a kid, wondering why there were different distinct layers in the dirt, before being called back by my mom to head back and sit with them at the gas station they worked at. Within the gas station, my solace was science-based TV shows on anything from animals to rocks, from cutting-edge medical technology to weapons. Similarly, I had cousins in Cambodia who had the same opportunity to explore the world around them but had parents equally too busy to explain to them the science behind it all.</p> <p>That said, I've been lucky to have been inspired by science educators to wonder more and ask questions throughout my schooling, and have a wish to pay it forward by inspiring future scientists and being able to mentor</p> |

them towards their goals and dreams. The Science Corps Fellowship is a fantastic opportunity for me to do so in a high impact area like the Philippines.

**In addition to your studies, please describe any prior experience that may help you as a Science Corps Fellow.**

I have varied experience in science outreach. Over my past six years being involved with the student chapter of SPIE at Texas A&M, I have developed different format STEM outreach activities for students such as tabling events about natural instances of luminescence, 45-min workshops on the principles of fluorescence guided surgery, and videos on other practical applications for luminescence, all for students in elementary school and middle school.

Separately, through my involvement in an NSF Engineering Research Center, I have prior experience facilitating two-day workshops for high schoolers. I was able to guide them through the entire engineering design process from problem statement to solution prototyping and meeting the students where they are.

For formal science education, I have TA'd two bioinstrumentation lab sections during COVID for ~30 students overall, and will TA three general chemistry lab sections for ~100 students this coming fall. Responsibilities included guiding the students through the week's lab, grading the lab reports, and providing feedback and guidance for the students about the course or their academics in general. In preparation, we were trained on how to develop learning outcomes and different teaching strategies for different contexts.

**Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.**

Doing science in industry

In science outreach

**Please expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (~2 year) and long-term (~10 year) future.**

In the near term, I plan to be working in the medical device industry ideally in the underserved space, and learning how to support healthcare accessibility, especially from the industry-specific side of things. In parallel, I hope to continue my involvement in local science outreach through hosting community STEM events, speaking at local schools and organizations, and developing portable learning modules that correspond with samples.

In the longer term, I see myself in a more managerial role within industry, while maintaining the science outreach and engagement with the community through hosting or speaking events. If the opportunity allows, I envision myself teaching university courses related to biomedical engineering as an adjunct professor.

**Please upload your CV (.pdf)**

 [250829\\_BK\\_CV.pdf](#)

**How did you find out about Science Corps?**

Referred by a friend/colleague/supervisor in academia